

LOOK OUT FOR

DIYA CHITALE

The 21-year-old opened her new year with a 3-0 win over senior and higher-ranked Ayhika Mukherjee in the qualifiers of the WTT Star Contender in Doha to make the main draw. This could very well be the harbinger of good things for the young paddler. Last year, she even defeated Manika Batra in the Ultimate Table Tennis, showing that she's not afraid to take on experienced players. As of January 7, Diya is ranked 122nd in the world. 2025 may very well be the season she breaks into the top 100, or beyond.



M. VEDHAN

PKL



AYAN LOHCHAB

Ayan Lohchab made a sensational Pro Kabaddi League (PKL) debut in the recently concluded Season 11, earning the coveted New Young Player award while playing for runner-up Patna Pirates.

This youngster showcased exceptional composure and skill throughout the season, amassing 184 raid points in 25 matches. Ayan dominated the mat, leaving defenders bewildered with his speed, agility, and precision. He recorded seven Super 10s while contributing nine valuable tackle points to his team's defence.

Ayan's fearless spirit and impressive adaptability have established him as a rising star in the world of Kabaddi.

PUJA TOMAR

2024 was an eventful year for Puja Tomar. She became one of the few Indians to secure a UFC contract and made history as the first from the country to win a bout in the promotion. She beat Rayanne dos Santos in her maiden bout via split decision. In the first quarter of 2025, the UP-born fighter will take on Ireland's Shauna Bannon. Puja's powerful jabs and strong ground-and-pound technique will help mitigate her reach disadvantage, giving her an excellent opportunity to register consecutive wins in the UFC.



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